

# Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

## Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India

### Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

|                        |                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Subject</b>         | Social Science (NCERT Class 7)       |
| <b>Chapter</b>         | 1 — Geographical Diversity of India  |
| <b>Total Questions</b> | 60 (Multiple Choice, single correct) |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b>   | 240                                  |
| <b>Suggested Time</b>  | 90 minutes                           |

**Marking scheme:** +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

**Instructions:** Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. A desert is defined by low rainfall not heat, the towering Himalayas are young and still rising while the worn Aravallis are ancient, and the tall unbroken Western Ghats on the west coast must never be swapped with the low broken Eastern Ghats on the east coast. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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**1.** A trekker starts in a belt of dense subtropical forest and famous hill stations, then descends to the youngest, lowest, gravel-built foothills before reaching the plains. The two zones described, in the order met, are:

- (A) the Shivalik foothills, then the Himachal ranges
- (B) the middle Himachal ranges, then the Shivalik foothills
- (C) the Himadri snow-peaks, then the Himachal ranges
- (D) the Himachal ranges, then the Himadri snow-peaks

**2.** Two ranges are compared: one carries permanent snow and the world's highest peaks, the other is famous for cool hill towns such as Shimla. A correct single statement tying altitude to this difference is:

- (A) both ranges are the same height, but one happens to face the sun
- (B) the hill-town range is higher, which is why it is cooler than the snow-peaks
- (C) the snow-bearing range is lower, which traps cold air at its base
- (D) the snow-bearing range is higher, so its thinner, colder air keeps snow year-round, while the hill-town range sits lower where the air is milder

**3.** A textbook states the Indian plate is still creeping northward into Asia. The most directly observable present-day consequence within the chapter's scope is:

- (A) the Aravallis are slowly gaining height
- (B) the Northern Plains are slowly rising above the sea
- (C) the Deccan Plateau is sliding into the Arabian Sea
- (D) the Himalayas are still slowly gaining height

**4.** Marine fossils sit in high Himalayan rock, yet no sea exists there now. The best single explanation is that:

- (A) an ancient sea once lay between the two landmasses, and its floor was folded up into mountains when they collided
- (B) the present-day Arabian Sea once flooded the peaks and then drained away
- (C) monsoon rivers carried the shells uphill and embedded them in the rock
- (D) the fossils formed inside the rock itself without any sea

**5.** The Himalayas are called Asia's water tower. Which chain of reasoning best shows why this matters to the plains below in the dry months?

- (A) the peaks pull rain clouds inland, so the plains get rain directly from the mountains all winter
- (B) the mountains pump seawater inland through underground channels to the plains
- (C) snow and glaciers store winter precipitation, then melt in summer, releasing water into rivers that keep flowing even without rain
- (D) the rock of the peaks soaks up monsoon water and squeezes it out in summer

**6.** Listing India's natural northern, western and southern barriers, a student must NOT include which of the following, because it is not one of the country's outer walls?

- (A) the Himalayas in the north
- (B) the Thar Desert with the Arabian Sea in the west
- (C) the Indian Ocean with the Bay of Bengal in the south
- (D) the Aravalli Hills, which lie inside the country

**7.** A farmer on the Northern Plains and a farmer on the Deccan Plateau both grow crops, but the plains support far denser farming. The deepest reason lies in the SOIL: the plains have:

- (A) thin soil over hard old rock, rich in minerals but harder to farm intensively
- (B) salty coastal soil washed in by sea tides
- (C) deep, soft, renewed alluvium spread by Himalayan rivers, easy to plough and very fertile
- (D) frozen soil that thaws only in summer

**8.** Why does drilling beneath the Northern Plains pass through kilometres of loose sediment before reaching hard rock, unlike drilling on the Deccan?

- (A) a thick sheet of cooled volcanic lava buried the bedrock there
- (B) ancient glaciers carved a canyon and packed it with ice that turned to rock

(C) the plains sit in a long trough that Himalayan rivers have been filling with eroded mountain sediment for millions of years

(D) the seabed was lifted up and left its soft mud on the surface

**9.** On a flood plain, the strip nearest the river receives fresh light silt each flood, while a higher older terrace nearby does not. Compared with the older terrace, the fresh strip is:

(A) less fertile, because flooding washes away its nutrients

(B) identical in fertility, since both are alluvium

(C) barren, because floods leave only sand and stone

(D) more fertile, because each flood lays down new nutrient-rich silt

**10.** Great cities and dense villages cluster on the Northern Plains rather than on the Shivalik foothills just above them. The clearest geographic reason is that:

(A) the foothills are too hot for people to live in

(B) the plains are the only place in India that receives rainfall

(C) flat, well-watered, fertile plains make farming, building and travel easy, while the rugged foothills make all three harder

(D) the foothills have no rivers of any kind

**11.** Trace the correct cause-and-effect order linking mountains, rivers and soil that explains the plains' fertility:

(A) silt settles first, then rivers form, then the mountains rise, then erosion begins

(B) uplift of the mountains, then rivers erode the rock, then silt is carried downstream, then it settles as fertile alluvium on the flat plains

(C) rivers carry silt first, then the mountains rise, then the silt grinds the rock away

(D) the mountains erode away completely, then a sea floods the plains, then rock rises

**12.** A student claims, 'The Aravallis are low, so they must be a young range that has not finished rising.' The correct correction is:

(A) they are low because they are young and still beginning to rise

(B) they are low precisely because they are extremely old and worn down by ages of erosion, not because they are young

(C) they are low because they are made of unusually soft sand

(D) they are low because they sank back beneath the surface

**13.** The Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri all reach the eastern sea, while the plateau they cross is described as 'tilted'. The eastward flow is best read as:

(A) evidence that the eastern sea sits higher and pulls the rivers toward it

(B) proof that the western edge of the plateau is lower than the eastern edge

(C) evidence that the plateau slopes gently downward toward the east, guiding the rivers that way

(D) a coincidence unrelated to the shape of the plateau

**14.** The Peninsular Plateau is one of India's richest sources of minerals and coal. The best explanation rooted in its origin is that:

- (A) Himalayan rivers wash fresh minerals onto it from the north every year
- (B) it is built of very ancient, hard, stable rock in which minerals and coal accumulated over vast time
- (C) ocean tides deposit minerals along its surface
- (D) glaciers grind mineral dust onto it from the peaks above

**15.** Standing on the west coast you see a tall, almost continuous mountain wall; on the east coast you see lower hills broken into gaps. The two walls are, respectively:

- (A) the Western Ghats (high and unbroken) and the Eastern Ghats (lower and broken by rivers)
- (B) the Eastern Ghats (high and unbroken) and the Western Ghats (lower and broken)
- (C) the Himadri on the west and the Shivaliks on the east
- (D) the Aravallis on the west and the Vindhya on the east

**16.** Why is the Deccan's western rim a tall continuous wall while its eastern rim is low and chopped into segments?

- (A) the western rim is a young range still rising while the eastern rim is ancient
- (B) the block is tilted so its western edge stands high, while east-flowing rivers have sliced gaps through the lower eastern edge
- (C) the sea long ago flattened the eastern rim but spared the western rim
- (D) the two rims are carved from totally different minerals

**17.** Dense forests of the central plateau are home to several long-settled tribal communities. These communities living there are best described as the:

- (A) herders of Ladakh's cold desert valleys
- (B) coral-island fishers of the Arabian Sea
- (C) forest-dwelling peoples such as the Gond and Bhil of the plateau interior
- (D) mangrove-delta dwellers of the eastern coast

**18.** The east coast carries broad fertile deltas while the west coast mostly does not. Combining river length, slope and sea calm, the reason is:

- (A) the west coast receives no rain, so its rivers carry no water
- (B) long, gentle east-flowing rivers drop heavy sediment into the calm Bay of Bengal, while short, swift west-flowing rivers carry little into the open Arabian Sea
- (C) the east coast has no rivers, only lakes and lagoons
- (D) deltas can form only where the sea water is salty

**19.** A river ends in a wide, fertile, fan of new land split by many channels; another ends in a single broad funnel where fresh and salt water mix but little land is built. The two mouths are, in order:

- (A) a delta, then an estuary
- (B) an estuary, then a delta
- (C) a lagoon, then a delta
- (D) two estuaries of different sizes

**20.** Chilika and Pulicat lie along the eastern shore. They are best classified as:

- (A) coral atolls of the Arabian Sea      (B) coastal lakes and lagoons of the east coast
- (C) glacial lakes high in the Himalayas      (D) crater lakes on the volcanic plateau

**21.** The Sundarbans and the Royal Bengal Tiger are linked to a single landform shared by two countries. That landform and the sharing pair are:

- (A) the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, shared by India and Bangladesh
- (B) the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, shared by India and Myanmar
- (C) the Indus delta, shared by India and Pakistan
- (D) the Kaveri delta, shared by India and Sri Lanka

**22.** Why does the west coast tend to form coves, creeks and estuaries rather than the great deltas seen in the east?

- (A) its rivers are short and swift and meet a rough, open sea, so they build little new land at their mouths
- (B) its rivers are the longest and slowest in India
- (C) it has no rivers reaching the sea at all
- (D) its sea is too cold for deltas to form

**23.** A coastal plain receives a long, sediment-laden, slow river flowing into a calm, sheltered sea. The most likely mouth landform is:

- (A) a narrow funnel-shaped estuary with little new land
- (B) a coral reef ringing the river mouth
- (C) a sand dune field at the river mouth
- (D) a wide delta of fertile new land

**24.** The northeastern hills record some of the heaviest rainfall on Earth, producing lush valleys and living root bridges. The mechanism responsible is:

- (A) the hills being the lowest land in India, so rain drains into them
- (B) moist monsoon winds forced to climb the hills, cool, and shed their moisture as very heavy rain
- (C) rivers evaporating uphill there and falling straight back as rain
- (D) salty sea spray blown directly onto the hilltops

**25.** Two island groups differ sharply: one is low, flat and ringed by coral; the other is higher, forested and built of volcanic rock. The low coral group and its sea are:

- (A) the Lakshadweep Islands, in the Arabian Sea
- (B) the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, in the Bay of Bengal
- (C) the Lakshadweep Islands, in the Bay of Bengal
- (D) the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, in the Arabian Sea

**26.** Which single idea best explains WHY one Indian island group is low coral and the other is high volcanic rock?

- (A) how an island forms decides its shape: coral builds up in warm shallow seas, while volcanoes rise where the Earth's plates interact
- (B) one group is far older than the other and has simply worn down
- (C) one group gets monsoon rain and the other receives none
- (D) the two surrounding seas are at different temperatures only

**27.** India's only active volcano sits in one of its island groups. Its presence tells us that that group is:

- (A) the coral Lakshadweep group in the Arabian Sea
- (B) the mangrove Sundarbans of the eastern delta
- (C) a glacial island chain in the Himalayan lakes
- (D) the volcanic Andaman & Nicobar group, raised where plates meet

**28.** A naturalist studying coral reefs that grow only in warm, clear, shallow seas would head to which Indian island group, and why?

- (A) the Andamans, because they are coral islands in the Bay of Bengal
- (B) the Sundarbans, because coral grows in mangrove mud
- (C) the Aravalli islands, because coral forms on old hills
- (D) Lakshadweep, because its islands are coral built up in the warm shallow Arabian Sea

**29.** Comparing the seas on either side of peninsular India, which statement correctly matches an island group to its sea?

- (A) Lakshadweep sits in the Arabian Sea to the west; the Andaman & Nicobar Islands sit in the Bay of Bengal to the east
- (B) Lakshadweep sits in the Bay of Bengal; the Andamans sit in the Arabian Sea
- (C) both groups lie in the Arabian Sea    (D) both groups lie in the Bay of Bengal

**30.** During April with no rain, the Ganga still flows strongly while many Deccan rivers shrink to trickles. The cleanest explanation is:

- (A) the Ganga is fed by melting Himalayan snow and ice all year, while the Deccan rivers depend mainly on seasonal rain
- (B) the Ganga is shorter, so it loses water more slowly
- (C) the Deccan rivers are blocked upstream by the Aravallis
- (D) the Ganga draws water inland from the sea

**31.** Which contrast between perennial and rain-fed rivers is stated correctly?

- (A) perennial rivers flow only during the monsoon, while rain-fed rivers flow all year
- (B) perennial rivers exist only in deserts, while rain-fed rivers exist only in mountains
- (C) perennial rivers flow all year on snowmelt, while rain-fed rivers swell in the monsoon and shrink afterward
- (D) both kinds carry the same amount of water in every season

**32.** Most peninsular rivers run east to the Bay of Bengal, but the Narmada and Tapi are exceptions. Their unusual behaviour is that they:

- (A) flow westward into the Arabian Sea, against the plateau's general eastward slope
- (B) flow north to join the Ganga on the plains
- (C) climb uphill into the Western Ghats
- (D) end inland without ever reaching any sea

**33.** A peninsular river and a Himalayan river start the dry season equally full. By late spring the Himalayan one is still strong. The single best reason for the difference is the Himalayan river's:

- (A) steady supply of meltwater from mountain snow and glaciers
- (B) greater number of lakes storing monsoon rain
- (C) shorter course that loses less water
- (D) connection to seawater pushed upstream by tides

**34.** Why does the Deccan Plateau, despite many rivers, support less intensive farming than the Northern Plains?

- (A) it has no rivers and almost no soil of any kind
- (B) its soil is thin over hard rock and its rain-fed rivers vary with the seasons, unlike the plains' deep alluvium and steadier water
- (C) it is permanently frozen for most of the year
- (D) it lies below sea level and floods constantly

**35.** A child argues that Ladakh cannot be a desert because deserts are scorching. The accurate reply is:

- (A) Ladakh actually receives very heavy rainfall, so the child is half right
- (B) deserts must always have tall sand dunes, which Ladakh lacks
- (C) a desert must lie below sea level, which Ladakh does not
- (D) a desert is any region with very little rainfall, so a cold place like Ladakh can be a desert too

**36.** Comparing the Thar and Ladakh, which single feature belongs to the COLD desert rather than the hot one?

- (A) towering golden sand dunes shaped by hot winds
- (B) taanka and kund tanks built to survive blistering heat
- (C) high salty lakes, bitterly cold winters, and animals like the snow leopard
- (D) scorching daytime sand and the absence of any frost

**37.** The Aravalli range is unusually effective at slowing the Thar's sand from spreading east. The reason is that it:

- (A) is extremely tall and snow-capped, chilling the desert winds
- (B) is made of loose sand that absorbs the blowing sand

(C) lies far to the south, where it catches the sand by chance

(D) runs as a long ridge along the eastern edge of the desert, physically blocking the wind-blown sand

**38.** If the Aravallis were leveled by mining, the most likely consequence within the chapter's scope would be:

(A) the Himalayas would stop rising

(B) the Thar's wind-blown sand would spread further east toward cities like Delhi

(C) the Ganga would reverse its direction (D) India would lose its western coastline

**39.** Thar villagers scrub pots with sand and store rain in taanka and kund tanks. The custom arises because:

(A) water is so scarce there that every drop must be saved and sand is used where water would be wasted

(B) sand is believed to clean better than any amount of water

(C) the nights are too cold to allow washing with water

(D) local rules forbid using river water for any chores

**40.** Mount Abu, the only true hill station of a particular range, marks the highest point of which range?

(A) the snow-covered Himadri range      (B) the high western coastal wall

(C) the ancient, worn Aravalli range      (D) the youngest Shivalik foothills

**41.** India lies roughly between 8 degrees and 37 degrees north of the Equator. This north-south spread mainly means that India:

(A) lies entirely within the cold temperate zone

(B) stretches across many latitudes, so its far south is hotter and more tropical than its far north

(C) has the same temperature everywhere because it is one country

(D) is split between the northern and southern hemispheres

**42.** The Tropic of Cancer runs across the middle of India. The most useful thing it tells us about the country is that:

(A) the whole of India lies south of the Equator

(B) roughly the southern half lies in the tropics, helping make that part warmer year-round

(C) India lies entirely beyond the tropics in the polar zone

(D) the line marks where the Himalayas meet the plains

**43.** Because India spans a wide east-west distance, the sun rises noticeably earlier in the far east than in the far west. The chapter uses this to show that India:



- (A) is so small that the sun rises everywhere at once
- (B) has a large longitudinal extent, so the eastern edge sees sunrise well before the western edge
- (C) lies entirely in one narrow strip of longitude
- (D) rotates faster in the east than in the west

**44.** The Tropic of Cancer (about 23.5 degrees N) runs right across the middle of India, passing through states such as Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal. A useful consequence of this for understanding India's climate is that:

- (A) the whole of India therefore lies in the temperate zone with cold winters everywhere
- (B) places lying exactly on the line never receive direct overhead sunlight at any time of year
- (C) it marks the physical boundary between the Northern Plains and the Himalayas
- (D) the land south of the line lies within the tropics and tends to stay hot through the year, while the land to its north has a more seasonal, subtropical climate

**45.** Both the latitudinal and longitudinal extents of India are large. Together, what do they help explain about the country?

- (A) why all of India shares one identical climate
- (B) why India has no seasons at all
- (C) its wide range of climates and the differences in local sunrise time across the land
- (D) why the Himalayas are still rising

**46.** If the Himalayas suddenly vanished, the most likely change to north India's climate would be:

- (A) north India would turn into a coral lagoon
- (B) the region would become a frozen polar desert with heavy snow
- (C) icy dry winds from Central Asia would sweep in and rain would fall less, because the wall that blocks the cold and traps the monsoon would be gone
- (D) nothing would change, since mountains do not affect climate

**47.** Orographic rainfall on the windward side of the Western Ghats and the soaking of the Khasi hills share the same cause. That cause is:

- (A) both regions lying next to large hot deserts
- (B) moist monsoon winds being forced to rise over high ground, cooling, and dropping heavy rain
- (C) both regions being built of coral that attracts rain
- (D) both regions lying below sea level where water pools

**48.** The windward, sea-facing slope of the Western Ghats is drenched while the land just behind the crest is much drier. The best explanation is that:

- (A) the sheltered side is a separate desert with its own dry climate unrelated to the Ghats
- (B) the sea-facing slope blocks all sunlight, cooling the back into a frost zone
- (C) the rising winds drop their rain on the windward slope, leaving little moisture for the sheltered side behind the crest
- (D) the rivers on the back side carry the rain away before it can fall

**49.** How does relief shape farming differently in the Northern Plains versus the high Himalayas?

- (A) the flat, fertile plains allow wide, intensive crop farming, while the steep, cold mountains limit farming to small terraces and herding
- (B) both regions farm the same crops on the same scale because they share rivers
- (C) the mountains farm more intensively because they are cooler
- (D) neither region can support any farming at all

**50.** Why do large cities and dense populations concentrate in the Northern Plains rather than in the Thar Desert?

- (A) the desert is too cold for people to survive
- (B) the plains are the only flat land in all of India
- (C) the plains offer fertile soil and reliable river water, while the desert's scarce water and poor soil limit how many people the land can feed
- (D) the desert has no sunlight for most of the year

**51.** Despite formidable natural barriers, traders and armies still entered India through history. This shows that the barriers:

- (A) never really existed as barriers at all
- (B) made movement harder but did not completely seal the country off
- (C) blocked only rivers, never people
- (D) were built by people rather than by nature

**52.** Which single combination of features best explains why India developed a distinctive climate and culture, somewhat sheltered from the wider world?

- (A) a scatter of random low hills with no overall pattern
- (B) the river deltas of the east coast acting alone
- (C) the coral reefs of Lakshadweep acting alone
- (D) the natural barriers of the Himalayas, the Thar with the Arabian Sea, and the surrounding oceans, which limited easy movement

**53.** A student must sort 'Ladakh, the Thar, and the Sundarbans' by landform type. The correct grouping is:

- (A) Ladakh a cold desert, the Thar a hot desert, the Sundarbans a mangrove delta
- (B) all three are hot deserts
- (C) all three are river deltas
- (D) Ladakh and the Thar are deltas, the Sundarbans a desert

- 54.** Why are peaks above 8,000 m found in the Himalayas but never in the Aravallis?
- (A) the Aravallis are submerged beneath the sea
  - (B) the Himalayas are flat plateaus rather than mountains
  - (C) the Aravallis are made of rock too soft to ever have been tall
  - (D) the Himalayas are young, still-rising fold mountains, while the Aravallis are ancient and worn far down
- 55.** How can great rivers like the Ganga be said to UNITE India's very different regions?
- (A) they give every region exactly the same weather
  - (B) they physically connect the Himalayas to the islands
  - (C) they link mountains, plains and coasts, carrying people, goods and ideas between distant places
  - (D) they make the whole country into one flat plain
- 56.** The chapter's central idea is that India's sharply different regions still form one nation. This is captured by the phrase:
- (A) survival of the fittest
  - (B) divide and rule
  - (C) out of sight, out of mind
  - (D) unity in diversity
- 57.** Why do geographers split a vast country like India into physical regions instead of treating it as one uniform space?
- (A) grouping land by height, slope, rock and water lets us compare regions and explain why life differs from place to place
  - (B) because every part of India looks exactly alike
  - (C) because ancient kings drew those boundaries
  - (D) because each region speaks one single language
- 58.** Pulling the chapter together, which statement best summarises how India's geography shapes its life?
- (A) all of India lives the same way because the land is the same everywhere
  - (B) only the Himalayas affect how Indians live; other regions do not
  - (C) geography has no effect on how or where people live in India
  - (D) each physical region shapes its own climate, wildlife and way of life, yet rivers and shared history still bind them into one country
- 59.** India's biodiversity, from snow leopards to mangrove tigers to coral fish, is so rich largely because:
- (A) the whole country has one warm climate that suits all animals
  - (B) all its animals were brought from other continents
  - (C) it has only one habitat, which all species share
  - (D) its many different physical regions and climates create many different habitats

**60.** A wildlife map shows the snow leopard high in the north, the Royal Bengal Tiger in an eastern mangrove delta, and coral fish around western islands. The best single conclusion is that:

- (A) all Indian animals can live in any region equally well
- (B) wildlife in India does not depend on geography at all
- (C) different physical regions give India very different wildlife suited to each habitat
- (D) every region of India shares the same animals

# Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India — Paper 3

## Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans |
|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|
| 1  | B   | 11 | B   | 21 | A   | 31 | C   | 41 | B   | 51 | B   |
| 2  | D   | 12 | B   | 22 | A   | 32 | A   | 42 | B   | 52 | D   |
| 3  | D   | 13 | C   | 23 | D   | 33 | A   | 43 | B   | 53 | A   |
| 4  | A   | 14 | B   | 24 | B   | 34 | B   | 44 | D   | 54 | D   |
| 5  | C   | 15 | A   | 25 | A   | 35 | D   | 45 | C   | 55 | C   |
| 6  | D   | 16 | B   | 26 | A   | 36 | C   | 46 | C   | 56 | D   |
| 7  | C   | 17 | C   | 27 | D   | 37 | D   | 47 | B   | 57 | A   |
| 8  | C   | 18 | B   | 28 | D   | 38 | B   | 48 | C   | 58 | D   |
| 9  | D   | 19 | A   | 29 | A   | 39 | A   | 49 | A   | 59 | D   |
| 10 | C   | 20 | B   | 30 | A   | 40 | C   | 50 | C   | 60 | C   |

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

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## Worked Solutions

**1. (B)** The middle (Himachal/Lesser Himalaya) belt holds the moderate-climate hill stations and forests; below it sit the geologically youngest, lowest Shivalik foothills built of river gravel, just above the plains. So descending you cross the middle ranges first and the foothills second. Putting the foothills first reverses the descent. The Himadri is the highest, snow-covered range and lies above, not below, the middle belt, so it cannot appear when descending toward the plains.

**2. (D)** Air grows colder and thinner with height, so the higher Himadri keeps permanent snow and the giant peaks, while the lower middle range is mild enough for hill stations. Saying they are the same height ignores that altitude is exactly what differs. Calling the hill-town range higher contradicts the fact that the snow range tops it. The snow range is not the lower one; its great height is the cause of the year-round snow.

**3. (D)** The continuing collision keeps squeezing and uplifting the young Himalayas, so they keep rising. The Aravallis are ancient and being worn down, not raised, by the

collision. The Northern Plains are a sinking trough being filled with silt, not lifted. The Deccan is a stable old block; the chapter never describes it sliding into the sea.

**4. (A)** The Himalayas rose when the floor of the old Tethys Sea was crushed and folded upward during the plate collision, lifting marine fossils to great heights. The Arabian Sea is a present-day ocean to the southwest, not a sea that climbed the peaks. Rivers flow downhill and could not carry shells up to the summits. Marine fossils are remains of sea creatures, so they record a former sea, not in-place rock formation.

**5. (C)** Frozen winter precipitation is locked as snow and glacier ice, then melts in the warm season, feeding rivers like the Ganga so they flow year-round even before the monsoon. The peaks do not deliver winter rain to the plains; the dry-season flow is meltwater, not rain. There is no underground pumping of seawater. The store is ice, not water squeezed from rock.

**6. (D)** India's outer barriers are the Himalayas to the north, the Thar plus the Arabian Sea to the west, and the surrounding ocean and seas to the south. The Aravallis are an interior range that slows the desert sand but does not form a national outer wall. The other three options are exactly the recognised outer barriers, so they belong on the list.

**7. (C)** Himalayan rivers blanket the flat plains with deep, fertile, renewable alluvium that is easy to till, supporting intensive farming and dense population. The Deccan's thin soil over hard rock is what limits it, so attributing thin-rock soil to the plains is backwards. Coastal salty soil and seasonally frozen soil describe other regions, not the alluvial Northern Plains.

**8. (C)** The plains lie in a subsiding trough in front of the rising mountains; rivers have poured eroded Himalayan material into it for ages, so soft sediment runs very deep. Volcanic lava built the Deccan, not the plains. There is no buried ice canyon described. The plains were not formed by lifted seabed mud; their fill is river-borne mountain debris.

**9. (D)** The newer floodplain silt (khadar) is renewed by each flood with fresh nutrients, so it is more fertile than the older, higher terrace (bhangar). Flooding deposits nutrients rather than only stripping them. The two alluviums are not identical in fertility, which is the whole point of the khadar/bhangar contrast. Fresh river silt is fine and rich, not barren sand and stone.

**10. (C)** Level, fertile, river-fed plains favour large settlements, intensive farming and easy movement, while broken hilly terrain hinders them, so people concentrate on the plains. The foothills are not uninhabitable from heat. Rainfall is not unique to the plains. Rivers descend through the foothills, so a total lack of rivers is false; the deciding factor is relief and soil, not absence of water.

**11. (B)** First the collision lifts the mountains; rivers then erode that high rock, carry the silt downstream, and finally deposit it as fertile alluvium on the level plains. The other

sequences scramble cause and effect: silt cannot settle before mountains and rivers exist, silt is the product of erosion rather than its cause, and the mountains have not eroded away nor has a sea flooded and lifted the plains.

**12. (B)** The Aravallis are one of the world's oldest ranges; immense time and erosion have worn them low. Youth would, if anything, mean active uplift like the Himalayas, so 'young' is the opposite of the truth. They are old folded rock, not a heap of soft sand. They have been eroded down, not sunk back below the ground.

**13. (C)** Rivers run downhill, so their consistent eastward course shows the plateau tilts down to the east. Water cannot be pulled toward a higher sea; the sea is the low end. The western rim (Western Ghats) is the high edge, not the low one, so saying the west is lower is wrong. A consistent direction across many rivers reflects the slope, not coincidence.

**14. (B)** The plateau's old, hard, stable crust has concentrated minerals and coal over enormous spans of time, making it mineral-rich. Himalayan rivers carry silt, not fresh mineral ores, onto the plains, not onto the high plateau. Tides act on coasts, not on the interior plateau surface. There are no plateau-top glaciers grinding minerals onto the Deccan; its wealth is inherent to its ancient rock.

**15. (A)** The west-coast wall is the high, nearly continuous Western Ghats, and the east-coast hills are the lower Eastern Ghats, broken where east-flowing rivers cut through. Swapping their heights and locations is the classic Ghats trap. The Himadri and Shivaliks are Himalayan ranges in the north, not coastal walls, so that pairing is out of place geographically.

**16. (B)** The plateau is a single tilted block: its raised western edge forms the high unbroken Western Ghats, while the rivers running off the tilt toward the east have carved gaps in the lower Eastern Ghats. Both rims are part of the same ancient block, so 'young and still rising' is wrong. The sea did not flatten the eastern rim; rivers cut it. The difference is the tilt and river erosion, not different minerals.

**17. (C)** The plateau's forests are home to tribal communities such as the Gond and Bhil. Ladakh's herders live in the northern cold desert, not the plateau. Coral-island fishers belong to the Arabian Sea islands, and mangrove dwellers to the eastern delta, both of which are different regions entirely.

**18. (B)** Long, slow eastward rivers gather and deposit large sediment loads into the calmer Bay of Bengal, building wide deltas; the short, steep west-flowing rivers reach the rough open Arabian Sea quickly with little sediment, so deltas are scarce there. The west coast does get heavy rain. The east coast clearly has major rivers, not only lakes. Sea saltiness is not what determines delta formation; sediment supply and a calm sea do.

**19. (A)** The branching fan of fertile new land is a delta; the single funnel where fresh and salt water mingle without building much land is an estuary, so the order is delta then

estuary. Reversing them mislabels each landform. A lagoon is a shallow coastal water body cut off by a bar, not the branching delta described, so that pairing is wrong too.

**20. (B)** Chilika and Pulicat are large coastal lakes and lagoons along the east coast, formed where bars and spits partly enclose seawater. They are not coral atolls, which belong to the Arabian Sea island group. They are not high Himalayan glacial lakes, nor are they volcanic crater lakes; their setting is the sea-fringed eastern coast.

**21. (A)** The Sundarbans mangroves and the Royal Bengal Tiger lie in the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, which India shares with Bangladesh. Myanmar lies to the east and does not share this delta. The Indus delta is in the northwest with Pakistan but is not the tiger's mangrove home. The Kaveri delta is in the far south and is not shared with Sri Lanka in this way.

**22. (A)** Short, fast west-flowing rivers reaching the open, rough Arabian Sea deposit little sediment, producing creeks, coves and estuaries rather than broad deltas. Their rivers are short and swift, not the longest and slowest. Rivers do reach the western sea. Sea temperature is not the controlling factor; river length, speed and the open rough sea are.

**23. (D)** A heavy sediment load delivered slowly into a calm sea settles and builds up, forming a wide delta. An estuary forms instead when a river is short and swift or the sea is rough enough to sweep sediment away. Coral reefs grow in warm clear shallow seas, not at silt-choked river mouths. Sand dunes are wind-built desert features, not river-mouth landforms.

**24. (B)** When humid monsoon air is pushed up against the hills it cools and releases enormous rainfall (orographic rain), creating the lush valleys and root bridges. The hills are uplands, not the lowest land collecting drainage. Rivers do not evaporate uphill to make rain. Sea spray does not produce record rainfall; rising, cooling moist air does.

**25. (A)** The low, flat coral islands are Lakshadweep, lying in the Arabian Sea off the southwest coast. The Andaman & Nicobar group is the higher volcanic one in the Bay of Bengal, so naming it as the coral group is wrong. Lakshadweep is not in the Bay of Bengal, and the Andamans are not in the Arabian Sea; the location pairing must match the formation.

**26. (A)** The contrast follows from origin: coral reefs build the low Lakshadweep in warm shallow seas, while volcanic activity raises the higher Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Age alone does not turn coral into volcanic rock. Both groups receive rain, so rainfall is not the cause. Slight sea-temperature differences do not explain the rock type; the formation process does.

**27. (D)** Barren Island, India's only active volcano, lies in the Andaman & Nicobar group, confirming its volcanic origin at a plate boundary. The coral Lakshadweep islands have no



volcano. The Sundarbans are a mangrove delta, not an island volcano group, and there are no glacial island chains in Himalayan lakes; the volcano marks the Andamans.

**28. (D)** Coral thrives in warm, clear, shallow water, and Lakshadweep is exactly such a coral island group in the Arabian Sea. The Andamans are volcanic, not coral, so they do not fit. The Sundarbans are muddy mangrove delta, where coral does not build islands, and the Aravallis are an inland hill range, not islands; only Lakshadweep matches the coral conditions.

**29. (A)** Lakshadweep lies in the Arabian Sea off the western (Kerala) side, and the Andaman & Nicobar Islands lie in the Bay of Bengal to the east. Swapping the two seas misplaces both groups. The two groups are not in the same sea; they sit on opposite sides of the peninsula, one west and one east.

**30. (A)** Snow- and glacier-fed Himalayan rivers like the Ganga receive meltwater even in the rainless dry season, so they stay full, whereas rain-fed peninsular rivers fall low without rain. The Ganga is long, not short. The Aravallis do not dam the Deccan rivers. Rivers flow to the sea and do not draw water inland from it; the difference is the source of supply.

**31. (C)** Perennial rivers, fed by melting snow and glaciers, flow throughout the year, while rain-fed rivers depend on the monsoon and dwindle in the dry season. Reversing those flow patterns is wrong. Perennial rivers are not desert features. And the two types clearly differ by season, so claiming identical year-round flow contradicts the definition.

**32. (A)** The Narmada and Tapti are notable for flowing west into the Arabian Sea, opposite to the usual eastward drainage of the tilted plateau. They do not turn north to the Ganga. Rivers cannot climb uphill into the Ghats. Both reach the sea, so claiming they end inland is false; their distinction is the westward course.

**33. (A)** The Himalayan river keeps flowing because melting snow and glaciers feed it continuously through the warm months, independent of rain. Lakes storing monsoon rain are not the chapter's explanation for sustained Himalayan flow. A shorter course is not why it stays full, and the Himalayan rivers are in fact long. Tidal seawater does not push upstream to sustain a river; meltwater does.

**34. (B)** The plateau's thin soil over hard ancient rock and its seasonally varying rain-fed rivers limit intensive farming, in contrast with the plains' deep fertile alluvium and snow-fed water. The Deccan does have rivers and soil, just less favourable ones. It is neither frozen year-round nor below sea level; it is a raised, warm plateau.

**35. (D)** Deserts are defined by very low rainfall, not by heat, so high, cold, dry Ladakh qualifies as a cold desert. Ladakh is dry, not heavily rained on. Sand dunes are common in hot sandy deserts but are not required for a region to be a desert. Elevation relative to sea level is irrelevant to the definition; rainfall is the key.

**36. (C)** Ladakh, the cold desert, has high salt lakes, severe winters and high-altitude animals such as the snow leopard. Tall golden dunes, heat-coping water tanks and scorching frost-free sand all describe the hot Thar Desert, not Ladakh. Both are deserts by low rainfall, but their temperature and features differ, so the cold-desert traits are the lakes, cold and snow leopard.

**37. (D)** The Aravallis form a long ridge on the desert's eastern flank, acting as a barrier to wind-driven sand moving toward cities like Delhi. They are low and worn, not tall and snow-capped. They are folded rock, not loose absorbing sand. And they lie along the eastern edge, not far to the south; their position and ridge form are what block the sand.

**38. (B)** The Aravalli ridge blocks eastward-moving desert sand, so removing it would let the Thar's sand spread east toward Delhi. The Himalayas rise from plate collision, unaffected by the Aravallis. The Ganga's course is set by the plains' slope, not by these hills. The western coastline is a sea boundary far away and unrelated to the Aravallis.

**39. (A)** In the dry Thar, water is precious, so people clean with abundant sand and harvest scarce rain in tanks. The practice is born of scarcity, not a belief that sand outcleans water. Cold nights are not the reason in the hot Thar. No rule bans river water; the point is that very little water is available, so it is conserved.

**40. (C)** Mount Abu is the highest point of the old, low Aravalli range. The Himadri carries giant snow peaks far higher than Mount Abu, so it is not that range's high point. The western coastal wall (Western Ghats) is a separate southern feature, and the Shivaliks are northern foothills; Mount Abu belongs to the Aravallis.

**41. (B)** A wide latitudinal spread means the southern, lower-latitude parts are warmer and more tropical, while the northern, higher-latitude parts are cooler, giving India varied climate. India does not sit wholly in a cold zone. Being one country does not make temperatures uniform; latitude varies them. India lies entirely north of the Equator, not split across hemispheres.

**42. (B)** The Tropic of Cancer crossing the middle places the southern half in the tropical zone, contributing to its warmth, while the north is subtropical. India is north of the Equator, not south of it. It is not in any polar zone. The Tropic is a latitude line, not a boundary between the Himalayas and the plains, so that reading is mistaken.

**43. (B)** A broad longitudinal extent means the eastern parts greet sunrise earlier than the western parts, since the Earth turns west to east. India is large, not small, so sunrise is not simultaneous everywhere. It does not occupy a single narrow longitude. The Earth rotates as one body; the east does not spin faster, the difference comes from longitude.

**44. (D)** The Tropic of Cancer is the northern limit of the belt where the Sun can be directly overhead. Land south of it lies within the tropics and stays warm all year, while land to its north is subtropical with sharper seasons. Because the line crosses the middle of

India, it neatly marks this climatic divide. India is not wholly temperate (its south is tropical); points on the Tropic do receive overhead Sun around the June solstice; and the Tropic is a line of latitude, not a relief boundary between the plains and the mountains.

**45. (C)** A large latitudinal spread gives varied climates from tropical south to cooler north, and a large longitudinal spread gives differing local sunrise times, so the two extents explain India's climatic variety and time differences. They do not produce one identical climate or remove seasons. The rising Himalayas come from plate collision, unrelated to the country's latitude-longitude extent.

**46. (C)** The Himalayas block frigid Central Asian winds and trap the rain-bearing monsoon; removing them would let in cold dry winds and reduce rainfall in the north. North India would not become a coral lagoon, which is a tropical sea feature. It would be drier and colder in winter, but the chapter does not predict a heavy-snow polar desert. Mountains clearly shape climate, so 'nothing changes' is wrong.

**47. (B)** In both places, humid monsoon air is pushed up the slopes, cools, and releases heavy rain, the orographic effect. Neither owes its rain to a neighbouring desert. Neither is built of coral, and rock type does not attract rain. Both are uplands, not below-sea-level basins; rising, cooling moist air is the shared mechanism.

**48. (C)** As moist winds climb the windward slope they cool and rain heavily there; having lost most moisture, the air gives little rain to the sheltered side, creating a drier zone behind the crest. The dry interior is a consequence of the Ghats, not an unrelated desert. The slope does not freeze the back side by blocking sunlight. Rivers carry water away after it falls, not the rain in the air.

**49. (A)** Flat, fertile, well-watered plains support large-scale intensive cropping, whereas steep, cold, thin-soiled mountains permit only small terraced plots and herding. Shared rivers do not make their farming identical; relief and climate differ greatly. Cooler mountains do not farm more intensively than the plains. Both regions do support some farming, so 'neither can' is false.

**50. (C)** Abundant water and fertile alluvial soil let the plains feed dense populations, while the dry Thar's scarce water and poor soil support far fewer people. The Thar is hot, not too cold to inhabit. The plains are not the only flat land; the Deccan and coasts are also flat in places. The desert is sunny, not sunless; water and soil, not sunlight, are the limiting factors.

**51. (B)** The barriers slowed but did not fully prevent contact, since traders and invaders found passes and sea routes through them. They certainly existed, so denying them is wrong. They restricted people, not just rivers. And they are natural features such as mountains and seas, not human-made walls; their effect was to hinder, not to seal completely.

**52. (D)** Together the Himalayas, the Thar plus the Arabian Sea, and the encircling oceans limited easy entry, helping India develop a distinct climate and culture. Random scattered hills do not form such a frame. The east-coast deltas alone are far too small a feature to shelter a subcontinent, and the Lakshadweep reefs are tiny and remote; it is the great outer barriers acting together that matter.

**53. (A)** Ladakh is a high cold desert, the Thar a hot sandy desert, and the Sundarbans a mangrove forest in a river delta, so each is a different type. They are not all hot deserts, since Ladakh is cold and the Sundarbans is a wet delta. They are not all deltas, since the two deserts are dry. Calling the deserts deltas and the delta a desert reverses the facts.

**54. (D)** The Himalayas are young, actively rising fold mountains that reach great heights, whereas the Aravallis are among the oldest ranges and have been eroded low over vast time. The Aravallis are above the surface, not submerged. The Himalayas are towering mountains, not flat plateaus. The Aravallis were once high folded rock, not soft material that was never tall; age and erosion explain the difference.

**55. (C)** Rivers flow from the mountains through the plains to the coasts, moving people, trade and ideas across regions and binding them together. They do not give all regions identical weather; climate still varies. They do not connect the mountains to the distant islands. They water and link the land but do not flatten the whole country into one plain; their uniting role is as routes of connection.

**56. (D)** 'Unity in diversity' expresses that India's many different landscapes, climates and peoples together make one country. 'Survival of the fittest' is about competition, not unity. 'Divide and rule' is a strategy of splitting people, the opposite of unity. 'Out of sight, out of mind' is about forgetting, unrelated to the chapter's theme.

**57. (A)** Dividing India by relief, rock and water makes it possible to compare areas and explain why climate, farming and ways of life vary across them. The regions are not all alike; that is precisely why they are distinguished. The physical regions follow nature, not royal boundaries. Language regions are a different matter and do not define physical geography.

**58. (D)** Mountains, plains, desert, plateau, coasts and islands each shape distinct climates, wildlife and lifestyles, while rivers and shared history tie them into one nation, which is the chapter's full message. The land is not the same everywhere, so lives differ. It is not only the Himalayas that matter; every region does. Geography clearly influences where and how people live.

**59. (D)** India's varied regions, from cold mountains to hot deserts, wet deltas and warm reefs, offer many different habitats, supporting a wide variety of life. The country does not have a single uniform warm climate; its climates differ greatly. Its rich native wildlife is not

all imported. Far from one shared habitat, it has many, which is exactly why biodiversity is high.

**60. (C)** Each animal lives where the region's relief and climate suit it, the snow leopard in cold mountains, the tiger in warm mangroves, coral fish in warm seas, showing geography shapes wildlife. The species are clearly specialised, so they cannot all live anywhere equally. Wildlife depends strongly on geography, and the regions do not share the same animals; their habitats differ.